

Payment Chronicle by Gajanan

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Companies: Square, Adyen

Article 1

Adyen plugs into Meal Ticket to power B2B foodservice payments

Foodservice distribution still runs on phone orders, invoices and checks. Meal Ticket, a vertical SaaS for distributors and manufacturers, is teaming up with Adyen to bake payments into those workflows. Think checkout inside order portals, pay links on invoices, and card/ACH acceptance tied to one ledger and one risk engine. Why it matters: embedded payments is where vertical SaaS makes money and sticks around, and Adyen loves platform deals that bring durable, B2B volume. For distributors, this could pull cash forward (lower DSO), tame reconciliation, and reduce write offs by making it easier for restaurants to pay on time. For buyers, it's fewer hoops and saved payment methods. For finance teams, one provider means cleaner settlement, centralized reporting and less PCI overhead. And because it's Adyen, expect access to multiple payment methods, global coverage and enterprise grade risk tools from a single stack. The bigger picture: B2B is the next battleground for embedded payments. By powering Meal Ticket, Adyen deepens its vertical SaaS beachhead while helping a paper heavy sector digitize collections and, potentially, optimize acceptance costs with richer transaction data.

Source: PaymentsDive

<https://www.paymentsdive.com/press-release/20240826-meal-ticket-partners-with-adyen-to-launch-payment-solutions-for-food-servic-1/>

Article 2

Adyen teams up with Plaid to push pay by bank and tame ACH risk

Adyen just plugged Plaid's open banking pipes into its checkout, and that could make "pay by bank" a lot more attractive for merchants tired of card fees. The tie up lets shoppers link bank accounts instantly via Plaid, while Adyen handles the payment processing, risk and acquiring under one roof. Translation: cheaper acceptance than cards, fewer failed ACH debits, and less friction at checkout. Plaid's tools (think account authentication, balance checks and risk scoring) aim to cut NSF returns and fraud—the big headaches that have kept ACH from prime time. For Adyen, this beefs up its alternative payments stack and helps woo high ticket, subscription and marketplace merchants who obsess over cost and conversion. For Plaid, it's another step from data rails into actual money movement. The catch? ACH still settles slower than cards and isn't universally loved by consumers, so this won't replace Visa/Mastercard overnight. But as interchange creeps up and network fees bite, expect more merchants to nudge users toward bank payments—especially for repeat bills and payouts. Net net: it's a smart play that chips away at card dominance and could widen Adyen's margin on the right merchant mix.

Article 3

Adyen brings Tap to Pay on iPhone to US merchants—no reader required

Adyen wants to kill the dongle. The payments platform is enabling Apple's Tap to Pay on iPhone for its US merchants, letting staff accept contactless cards and Apple Pay straight on an iPhone—no extra hardware, pairing, or cables. It supports the usual suspects (Visa, Mastercard, AmEx, Discover) on iPhone XS and newer, and plugs into merchants' existing apps via Adyen's SDK. The big picture? Lower hardware costs, faster onboarding, and more flexible in-store experiences—from line busting and pop ups to curbside. For Adyen, it strengthens the omnichannel pitch: one platform to handle online and in person transactions without a suitcase of terminals. It also pushes "softPOS" further into the mainstream, nudging retailers to think software-first and putting pressure on traditional terminal makers. There are caveats—enterprise requirements like complex peripherals, receipt printing, or specific workflows may still need dedicated kit—but this is a meaningful step in turning phones into full blown points of sale. If you run payments, the move is a nudge to pilot hardware light setups, rethink device fleets, and double down on integrating payments into your app stack where the customer experience—not the terminal—does the talking.

Article 4

Adyen eyes a holiday BNPL boom

'Tis the season for impulse buys — and buy now, pay later (BNPL) is set to spike again. With Swedish BNPL giant Klarna and its peers pushing hard at checkout, Adyen, the Dutch processor powering many of those checkouts, stands right in the flow of growing alternative payment volumes. Why this matters: BNPL has gone from novelty to necessity for retailers because it lifts conversion and average order values. Merchants increasingly want one integration to offer Klarna, Affirm, Afterpay and more across markets, and Adyen's unified platform, risk tools and smart routing help approvals and reduce checkout friction. The implication for Adyen is straightforward: more holiday volume, deeper merchant stickiness, and a richer mix of alternative payments. The catch? BNPL economics differ — providers take a larger cut, while processors earn on throughput, not lending margins — so scale and acceptance rates are key. Add regulatory scrutiny and credit risk to the backdrop, and orchestration becomes the differentiator. Bottom line: if BNPL is the festive feature, the platforms that make it seamless win. Adyen is positioning as the neutral pipes behind that growth.

Article 5

Square flips the switch on Bitcoin payments for small businesses

Small businesses are feeling the tech FOMO, and Square just handed them a crypto lifeline. The company is adding bitcoin payment acceptance to its checkout and POS tools—letting customers pay in BTC while merchants can auto-convert to dollars to sidestep price swings. The pitch is simple: faster settlement (think Lightning rails), potentially lower fees than card networks, and a way to tap global, cardless customers. For the payments industry, this isn't a wild crypto bet; it's Square quietly becoming a multi-rail processor—cards, wallets, bank transfers, and now bitcoin. The upside is clear for niche use cases like cross-border sales and digitally native audiences. The catch? Consumer demand is still patchy, refunds and reconciliations are different for “push” crypto payments, and tax/reporting rules vary by market. Expect merchants to treat this as an optional toggle—useful for marketing and fee experiments rather than core volume. If Square makes it truly one-click with clean compliance and instant fiat settlement, rivals may need to offer similar crypto rails or sharpen pricing. Bottom line: bitcoin is graduating from hype to checkout, cautiously.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-adds-bitcoin-payments-and-upgrades-ai-for-small-businesses/>

Article 6

Square tests Bitcoin at the till with first coffee purchase in D.C.

Square just ran a real-world Bitcoin checkout at a Compass Coffee in Washington, D.C., flipping the switch on its new point-of-sale support for crypto. It's a small swipe (well, tap) with big implications. For merchants, Square's move could turn Bitcoin from a speculative asset into a practical payments rail—likely using instant conversion to USD to dodge price volatility—while potentially undercutting card fees. For Square (Block), it's a chance to stitch together a closed loop: Cash App wallets paying Square merchants, with Lightning fast settlement and fewer intermediaries. That threatens the traditional interchange economics of Visa and Mastercard, at least on the margin, and gives Square another lever in merchant acquisition. The catch? Consumer demand for paying with Bitcoin is still niche, refunds and chargebacks aren't as clean, and compliance (think AML and travel rule) is heavier than swiping a card. But if Square can hide the crypto complexity and make the experience as simple as tap-to-pay, expect more pilots and coffee-shop proof points. Payments execs should watch the economics: lower acceptance costs and faster settlement could be compelling if the volume shows up.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/squares-platform-sees-first-bitcoin-payment-at-coffee-shop/>

